DOMAIN 2

alphared

Orbyte Smart SME Challenge: Less Busywork, Better Business

Problem Statement & Marking Rubric

Replit

runpod

Instagram: @sdc_xmumhack ***Email:*** sdc.xmumhack@gmail.com

ORBYTE SMART SME CHALLENGE: LESS BUSYWORK, BETTER BUSINESS

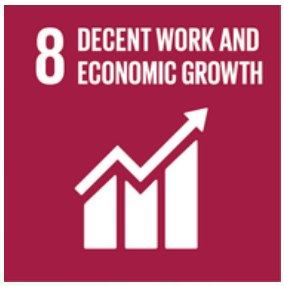
Domain sponsor

Alpha Red Solutions Sdn Bhd

Difficulty

Intermediate

Main SDG



Relevant SDGs



Targets: 8.2 productivity through technological upgrading and innovation · 8.3 support for entrepreneurship and the growth of micro, small and medium-sized enterprises

Teams may also link their solution to SDG 10 (Reduced Inequalities) or SDG 12 (Responsible Consumption and Production) where it genuinely supports them.

The Problem Statement

How might we design a reliable, easy-to-learn automation product for the Orbyte ecosystem that removes one recurring operational burden for micro and small businesses, improves accuracy and consistency, and keeps people in control, so it can serve many SMEs?

1. Background

Turn everyday business friction into an automation product SMEs will want to use.

Many micro and small businesses rely on manual follow-up, disconnected applications, spreadsheets and messages. Owners may spend evenings chasing supplier orders, customer enquiries, quotations or payments, and missed deadlines and stock shortages can follow.

Smaller businesses often cannot afford custom systems, or the time and cost of training staff on complex ones. They need work to be done accurately and consistently by people with different levels of digital confidence. A useful automation must connect to the right business information, respect roles and permissions, route decisions for human approval and leave a record of actions.

Orbyte's approach brings these functions together in a shared business hub. That foundation can help new solutions connect with more services and reach a wider market of SMEs without each builder starting from scratch. This challenge invites you to act as product founders and turn one real SME pain point into an easy-to-learn, scalable automation product for the Orbyte ecosystem.

Ideas to get you started (examples only, not a prescribed list):

- Chasing supplier orders, customer enquiries, quotations or payments
- Bookings, e-invoicing readiness and licence renewals
- Reducing food or material waste, or utility costs

2. Who You Are Building For

Owners and small teams of Malaysian micro and small businesses that rely heavily on WhatsApp, spreadsheets, paper and manual follow-up to manage their daily operations.

3. What to Build

Act as product founders and build a functional MVP for an automation product that an SME would want to adopt. It may be a web or mobile application, an intelligent agent, an API service or a working proof of concept. It should demonstrate one complete journey:

1. **Trigger.** A business event or request starts the work.
2. **Connected data.** The automation pulls together the relevant business information.
3. **Decision logic.** Rules or AI (only where it adds value) decide what should happen.
4. **Human approval.** A person with the right role approves the consequential action.
5. **Visible outcome.** The action completes, the user sees the result, and it is recorded in an activity log.

Show how the Orbyte approach makes the solution easier to learn, integrate, govern and reuse. Login, user profiles and role-based access control (RBAC) may be simulated; you do not need to build these platform foundations. Create your own synthetic data and interface or API assumptions. Your pitch should present the MVP as a potential startup product that could serve many SMEs through Orbyte; you do not need access to the live platform.

4. Must-Have Features

Your final product must include all of the features below. In the preliminary round, your proposal should explain how you will deliver each one, and your demo should show the most important one working.

Feature	What we expect
1. One clear SME problem	Address one clearly defined and meaningful problem faced by SMEs.
2. Core automated journey	Demonstrate one core automated journey from a business input to a useful outcome, using AI only where it adds value.
3. Accuracy and ease of learning	Show how the workflow improves accuracy and consistency and can be understood without costly formal training.
4. People stay in control	Show who may view or act on the data, a human approval before a consequential action, and a simple activity or audit record. These may be simulated; a full identity system is not required.
5. Orbyte fit and reuse	Explain how the idea fits Orbyte as a connected hub and could be adapted for many SMEs.
6. Business benefit and SDG	State the expected business benefit (e.g. time saved, errors avoided, tasks completed without training) and the SDG contribution.

5. Good-to-Have Features (Optional)

These are not required and are not scored separately. They strengthen your score under Innovation & Creativity or Problem-Solution Fit.

- **Real-world validation:** test the problem or prototype with real SME owners or staff and share what you learned. This is an advantage, not a requirement.
- **Automatic triggers:** use events, schedules, business rules or an intelligent agent to start work automatically, with appropriate human oversight.
- **Explainable decisions:** give recommendations based on connected business context, and hand missing information or exceptions clearly to a human.
- **Reusable building block:** create a connector, module or API that other solutions could build on.
- **Business model:** propose a usage-based, transaction-based, freemium or partner model suited to the Orbyte ecosystem.
- **Growth path:** show how the same innovation could reach different SMEs, connect with partner services and expand into other markets.

6. Rules and Boundaries

- **Genuine SME need:** the problem must be real, in areas such as sales, customer service, finance, procurement, inventory, compliance, marketing, sustainability, logistics or market access.
- **Add something new:** your solution must add a distinct SME business capability, not reproduce Orbyte's existing HR and administrative functions.
- **Fit the hub:** the concept should fit Orbyte's role as a shared business hub that brings functions, information and services together, not an unrelated standalone product.
- **Reusable:** design for many SMEs, not one organisation's internal process.

- **Focus:** demo one clear use case. Broader features can be presented as a future roadmap.
- **Creative freedom:** you may invent capabilities and experiences, and you do not need to copy Orbyte's current screens, but the concept should stay consistent with Orbyte's platform approach.
- **Data and privacy:** use only team-created synthetic data, with no real personal, customer or company records. Briefly explain how privacy and Malaysia's PDPA principles would be handled in a real deployment.
- **Out of scope:** processing real payments, submitting statutory filings, and giving legal or financial advice. You may demo preparatory workflows using synthetic data.

7. Support and Data

Alpha Red Solutions will give a high-level briefing on Orbyte's purpose and functional approach.

No dataset, mock API, sandbox, production access, customer data or dedicated mentoring is provided. Create your own synthetic data, interfaces, data structures and API assumptions.

8. What Success Looks Like

> *A strong prototype completes one SME task more accurately and consistently with fewer manual steps. A new user can understand the journey without formal training, and the team demonstrates appropriate permissions, human approval and a simple activity record. It also explains the measurable benefit and how the solution could serve many SMEs through Orbyte.*

— Alpha Red Solutions

9. Marking Rubric – Preliminary Round

The preliminary round judges your proposed idea and gives you first proof that you can build it. You do not need a finished product, but you do need a rough, working version of your single most important feature, shown live and backed by your GitHub repository.

Criterion	Weight	What judges look for in this domain
Innovation & Creativity	**30%**	A specific, real SME pain point rather than "SMEs are inefficient", and an original automation product with clear appeal and market potential. AI is used only where it adds value. Not a re-skinned chatbot or a copy of Orbyte's existing HR and admin features.
Problem-Solution Fit	**25%**	Removes one recurring operational burden, improves accuracy and consistency, and is easy to learn. People stay in control through permissions, human approval and an activity record. Fits Orbyte as a connected hub, is reusable across many SMEs, and stays within the stated boundaries.
Feasibility of Build	**25%**	The core automated journey (trigger → data → decision → approval → outcome) running live, even roughly, and backed by the GitHub repo. Synthetic data and the team's own interface or API assumptions are in place. The team names its hardest risk and has a plan or fallback, without depending on access to the live Orbyte platform.
Clarity of Proposal	**20%**	The proposal follows problem → approach → expected outcome, and the expected outcome names a measurable benefit (e.g. time saved, errors avoided). Someone hearing it cold could explain it back. It follows the submission format and length limits.
Total	**100%**	

How judging works

- A criterion's score is its weight multiplied by the band's percentage.
- A GitHub repository link is required. Make sure it is public or accessible to judges and reflects what you demo.
- Your preliminary score does not carry forward. The final round uses a different rubric, which will be shared with finalists.

Questions? Contact the organizers through the Discord.